

On the factors describing flowstate; A cognitive perspective

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1 Introduction

In an increasingly digital society, many teenagers and young adults find issues struggling to focus academically as distractions become ever more prevalent, many new terms such as "flow state" and the state of being "locked in" having increasingly used in social media platforms describe "flow", or, the mental state of total deep engrossment/absorption in a cognitive work and an ensuing loss of self-consciousness.[?] This state is linked to "optimal improvement in performance" and "positive outcomes"[?]. This is particularly an important field of research for our target population of teenagers and young adults due to the large amount of learning in this stage in life according to piaget's theory of development (or maybe just mention because they're transitioning into higher level academic research and requires a lot of heavy learning to happen in a more fancy way?). It is considered "the bottom line of existence (because) without it there would be little purpose in living.". [?]

Modern research has identified 9 characteristics of flow the flow experience. The challenge skill balance is often considered the backbone of flow research. This characteristic suggests that flow is reached when the perceived challenge of the task matches the skill level of the participant. Illustrated in figure 1. This parallels to Vygotsky's "Zone of Proximal Development" which is being in a skill level where it requires help from a more knowledgeable other rather than being impossible nor able to be done without any external assistance.

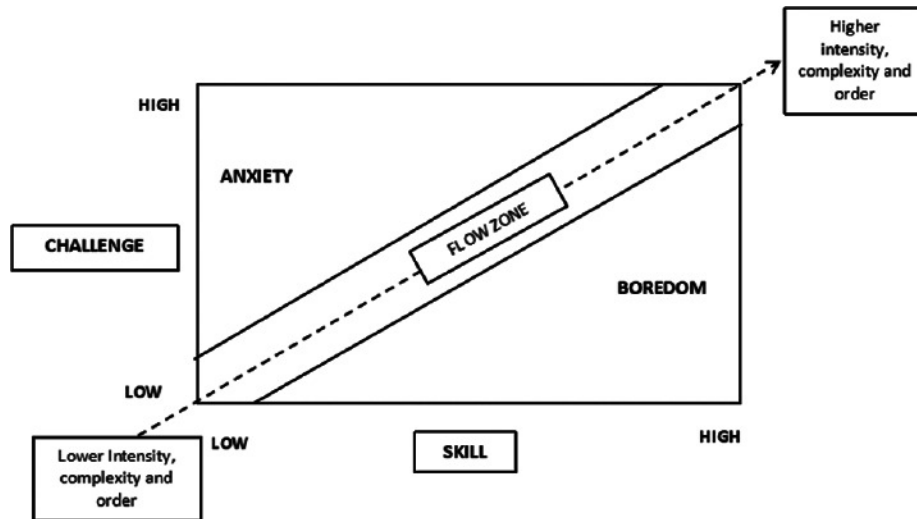


Figure 1: The challenge-skill balance model of flow state

However, many other factors were later discovered in relating to flow, such as perceived control,

This research will focus on the effect of $\square$ on the magnitude of flow when measured in differing times of an experiment (sounds shit and unclear)

2 Methodology

3 Designing the Data Collection

Many methods of data collection for flow has been used such as the four-channel model ratio of challenge and skill, and a classification based on ratings of absorption, timelessness and effort [?]. However, we will focus on using a classification based on absorption, timelessness and effort. Since this better describes the effects of flow rather than the theoretical preconditions that affect flow such as skill-challenge balance. For instance, being in flow, one would certainly feel absorbed in the task, as per the definition of flow. However, it does not mean that this is inherently caused by a equal balance of challenge and skill. So to focus on the result and the level of flow, we must resort to the definition of the effects of flow rather than the theoretical preconditions of flow.

Operationalized variables: The level of flow should be experimentally determined by the following factors Potential speculated factors affecting it

The tool itself:

1. questionnaire/survey
2. experiment

3. observation

4. interview

you can only do 5 items anyways

the explanation of the decisions explain, not describe it has to be effective, valid, and reliable your tool needs to match the population. it has to be relevant to the population

Survey

potential challenges

I think I will be doing experiment, doing an assignment, throughout different times of the day. and recording factors such as food consumption, what you were doing earlier (productive/relaxing work), etc. And then seeing what factors most visibly affected the flowstate or if they even were able to achieve flowstate we use a standardized test I forgot what it was called but I am certain there are many ways of doing it. if they didn't achieve flowstate, explain why they didn't

4 Discussion

Discussion of the potential findings of the investigation and the implications for policy/practice how it can potentially be used for making policies of the school for instance. *start with a paragraph bias:

1. how might've bias influenced

2. your personal history (are you involved?)

each criteria/section should have 3 paragraphs

potential findings are described in detail, and implications for policy/practice

relevant examples of how researcher bias is influenced (one is enough, I can talk about confirmation bias)

one relevant additional research method with reference to increasing the understanding of the area of investigation